

headphones or earphones that have a capable microphone. Note: Check carefully if the headphones you're considering has an inline microphone. We recommend headphones such as the Beyerdynamic MMX 102IE, RHA S500I, SoundMAGIC E10S, Brainwavz Omega and the Panasonic RP-HXD3W. Additionally, you can also



Tabletop mics such as The Audio-Technica AT2020 Studio Mic can help you take your recordings to the next level

buy external microphones to completely embrace the 'pro-singer' setup. You can get a handheld stage mic or even a tabletop recording mic. These are pricier than the headphones we've listed above, but if you master finding the right levels when recording with these, you will feel like a complete rockstar and the audio will turn out to be crisp and detailed.

CHOOSING EFFECTS MINDFULLY

Smule offers users a wide array of effects to polish their recording and enhance it immensely to make it sound more professional. Typically, if you're recording a track within the confines of a room, go with effects such as Super Studio, Studio FX

or Polish. These will ensure that your recording doesn't have too much echo and sounds more polished. Also, if you're extremely serious about your Smule career or even, hobby, you should consider getting the monthly or annual subscription since this will open up a whole new world of advanced filters and effects that you can use. A subscription plan also allows you to sing solo songs, whereas customers using the free version are deferred to only duets. Super Studio, one of the most popular effects on Smule, allows you to customise the effects applied to your voice depending on the dimensions of your room and the arrangement you're using. For example, you can increase the 'room size' option in Super Studio to compensate for a lack of acoustics.



SORRY, ANDROID USERS!

You can definitely use and create an amazing profile on Smule even with an Android phone in your possession, but there's no doubt that there are certain advantages to having the iOS version of this app since it was originally created for this platform. The iOS app gives

you access to advanced features such as being able to pause your recording at any time and correct a part



Choosing the right effects on Smule is integral

QUICK TIPS

- 1** Location is integral. Make sure you're not singing in a crowded area, or even your bathroom since it can create an unpleasant reverb. Try to stick to a quiet room that has plenty of furniture.
- 2** Do not keep the microphone extremely close to your mouth since it will create a distorted sound. Hold it at a distance of about 4 inches for a natural sound, and if you're singing loud, hold the mic around 12 inches away for the best effect.
- 3** If you are singing directly into the phone's microphone since that works the best for
- 4** If your phone or mic is placed on a table, ensure that it isn't a reflective surface since your voice will tend to bounce off it and cause issues such as heavy reverb and distortion.
- 5** Follow the notation or pitch bar at all times while singing and adjust your pitch in accordance with the bar.
- 6** You can purchase reflection filters such as the CAD Audio Stand Mounted Acoustic Enclosure to eliminate unwanted echos within your room.
- 7** Record the video, essentially lip-sync to your recording, after you've sung the song, since the video can prove to be a distraction at times.

you, avoid placing your hand or fingers over the mic to ensure your voice is not muffled.

of your recording by singing over the original piece. On Android devices, if you've made an error, you will have to go through the gargantuan task of recording the entire song again. The iOS app also has a functionality called 'lyrics scroll' which allows you to scroll through the lyrics and essentially skip parts that you're not recording, which is especially useful when it comes to duets. Additionally, on Android devices, you can only hear your voice with the effects applied after you've gone through the arduous process of recording the entire track, which is not the case on iOS. **4**